Single Mild Thyroid-Test Abnormality

CASE 05 | FICTIONAL PERSON | NO REAL PATIENT DATA

Synthetic model-evaluation document. Not for clinical use. Do not use these values to make decisions about a real person.

Primary care note

A 34-year-old nonpregnant woman is seen for mild fatigue following a febrile respiratory illness that resolved two days before blood collection. She has no persistent cold intolerance, constipation, weight change, or neck symptoms.

Examination note: pulse 76 beats/min. No goiter, thyroid tenderness, tremor, or eye findings are recorded.

Relevant history	No thyroid disease, pituitary disease, thyroid surgery, or radioiodine exposure.
Medication and supplements	No thyroid medication, lithium, amiodarone, or biotin supplement.
Pregnancy	Pregnancy test negative.
Collection	One sample only; no repeat thyroid test has been collected.
Prior results	No earlier TSH or free T4 result is available.

All names, dates, histories, values, intervals, and notes in this case are fabricated.

Thyroid laboratory report

Results are from a single serum sample collected during early recovery from the recent illness.

Test	Result	Unit	Printed reference interval	Report flag
TSH	5.8	mIU/L	0.40 - 4.00	H
Free T4	1.10	ng/dL	0.80 - 1.80	
Free T3	2.9	pg/mL	2.3 - 4.2	
TPO antibody	14	IU/mL	< 35	
CRP	8.4	mg/L	< 5.0	H
CBC	Within reference intervals			

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Timing and missing evidence

The respiratory illness included fever for four days. The patient was afebrile when blood was collected but reported residual congestion and reduced appetite.

There are no repeat thyroid results, no prior trend, and no documented thyroid-directed treatment. The laboratory notes that its TSH result is mildly above the adult interval.

Test	Result	Unit	Printed reference interval	Report flag
TSH before illness	Unavailable			
TSH after recovery	Unavailable			
Free T4 trend	Unavailable			
Current reference interval	TSH 0.40 - 4.00 mIU/L; free T4 0.80 - 1.80 ng/dL			

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